

Join the Discord!



DevLUp FSU



GBM #5



**(Game) Music for
Nonmusicians**

Upcoming jams: Brackey's 2026.1 (Feb 15-22)
12 February, 2026

Our Meeting Schedule:

Date	GBM	GBM Title	Secondary Event	Presenter
9 Jan		(No Meeting)	(Involvement fair?)	
15 Jan	1	Intros, Icebreakers, and Retrospectives		Everyone
21 Jan	2	Unity 201 (what new things?)	In the Co-Lab	Jake
29 Jan	3	2D Art -- Pixel and ...not pixel?	In the Pitch Room ↓	Calvin & Ares
5 Feb	4	2D Animation -- Frames and Tweening	(May have to move)	Calvin & Ares
12 Feb	5	Making Music for Non-Musicians		Marsh
19 Feb	6	Blender 201 -- Tidbits		Hailie
26 Feb	7	Unity 202 -- Lighting	Florida Comedy Jam (27-1)	Jake & Marsh
5 Mar	8	Writing For Games		Screenwriting Club
12 Mar	9	1 HOUR LEVEL DESIGN JAM		David
19 Mar		Spring Break		
26 Mar	10	Sound Design and the Art of Foley	(May have to move)	Yusong
2 Apr	11	Unity 203 -- A*, Agents and Navmesh		Jake & Marsh
9 Apr	12	Online Portfolios (HTML Basics) -WICS collab		Hailie
16 Apr	13	Prototyping Levels	(May have to move)	Marsh
23 Apr	14	Year's Out Celebration!		Everyone

DEVLUP @ FSU X UF X FIT X USF X UCF

Make the funniest game in Florida.

Florida Comedy Game Jam

For programmers, artists, designers,
musicians, and all sorts of comedians.

February 27th 6:00 PM - March 1st 6:00PM
at the Garnet Gaming Lounge



Join the Discord
for news & updates



#👁️showoff

Workshop Plan

- Bosca Ceoil
- Bare-minimum music
- Rhythm
- Melody
- Harmony
- Actiiiiiivty

<https://terrycavanagh.itch.io/bosca-ceoil>

FILE **ARRANGEMENT** **INSTRUMENT** 

BOSCA CEOIL

v1.0

Created by Terry Cavanagh
Sf000 softsynth library by Kei Mesuda
Distributed under FreeBSD license

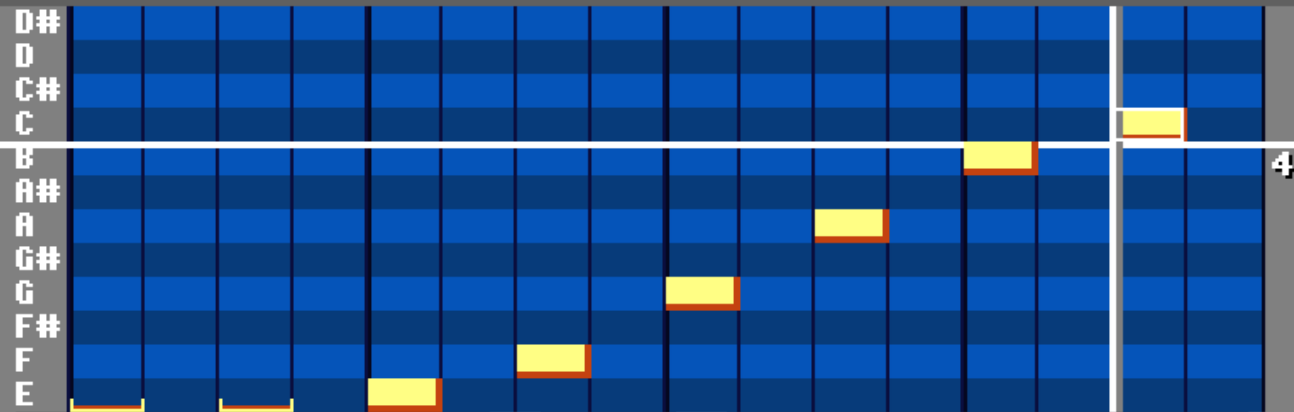
<http://www.distractionware.com>

NEW SONG **EXPORT .wav**

LOAD .ceol **SAVE .ceol**

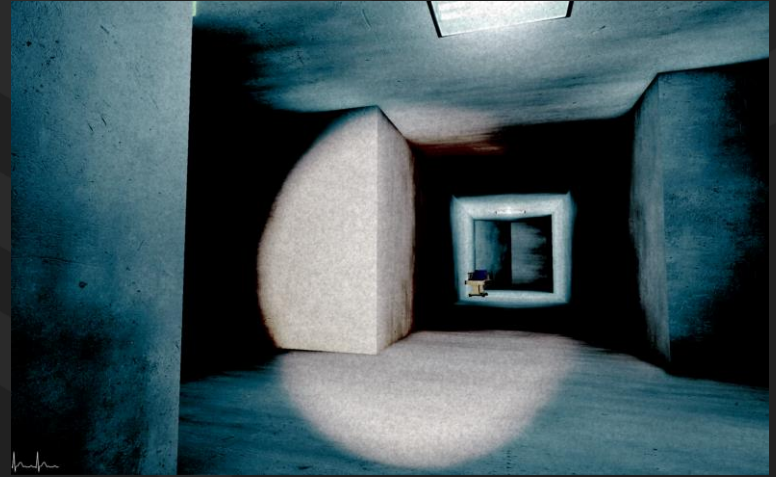
PATTERN ▼ 4 ▼ 16

BPM ◀ 120 ▶



▲ 1 Grand Piano ▲ C ▲ Scale: Normal

Activity: in teams of 3 or 4, create a looping music track for one of these games:



“Bare-minimum music”



Reasons to have music in one's game

- Tone-setting
- Adds dimension to the game / fills space
- Conveys gameplay info

Diegetic vs. Non-Diegetic Sound Sources

Diegetic



Non-Diegetic



Implementations of Game Music

- Looping
- “Shuffleplay”
- Adaptive
- Procedural/Generative
- Ambient
- Total absence of music!

Looping Music

- “It is an unpleasant experience to listen to the same song ten times in a row”
- Thus, looping music must:
 - Have a beginning which cleanly intercepts the ending
 - Evade seeming as a single piece of music that is played many times
 - Undetectable pattern of progression and regression



Progression in looping music

Avoiding fatigue:

Shepard Scales/Risset Rhythms

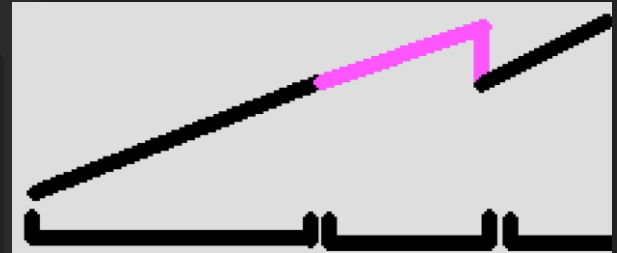
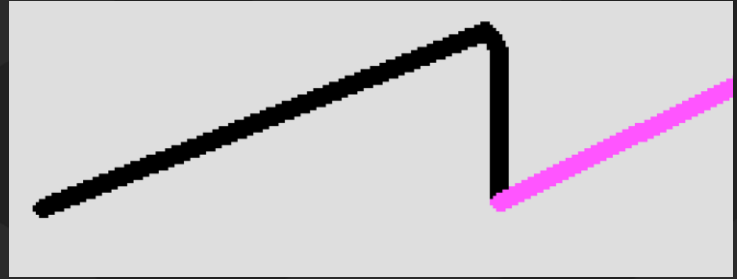
No landmarks

Veil when the music is restarting

Vary looping segments (perhaps only with little variation)

Building:

Non-looping intro with looping body?



Rhythm

- Beats and measures - accent first beat strongly, third beat weakly
 - BPM - 90, 120, 140
 - Not all tracks need percussion but...
 - ...it's a cheap way to build excitement
 - ABACABAD structure for basic drums
 - Have multiple layers of percussion!
-
- Start with a kick
 - Snares between the kicks
 - Fill in different subdivisions of beats for flavor

Melody

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16

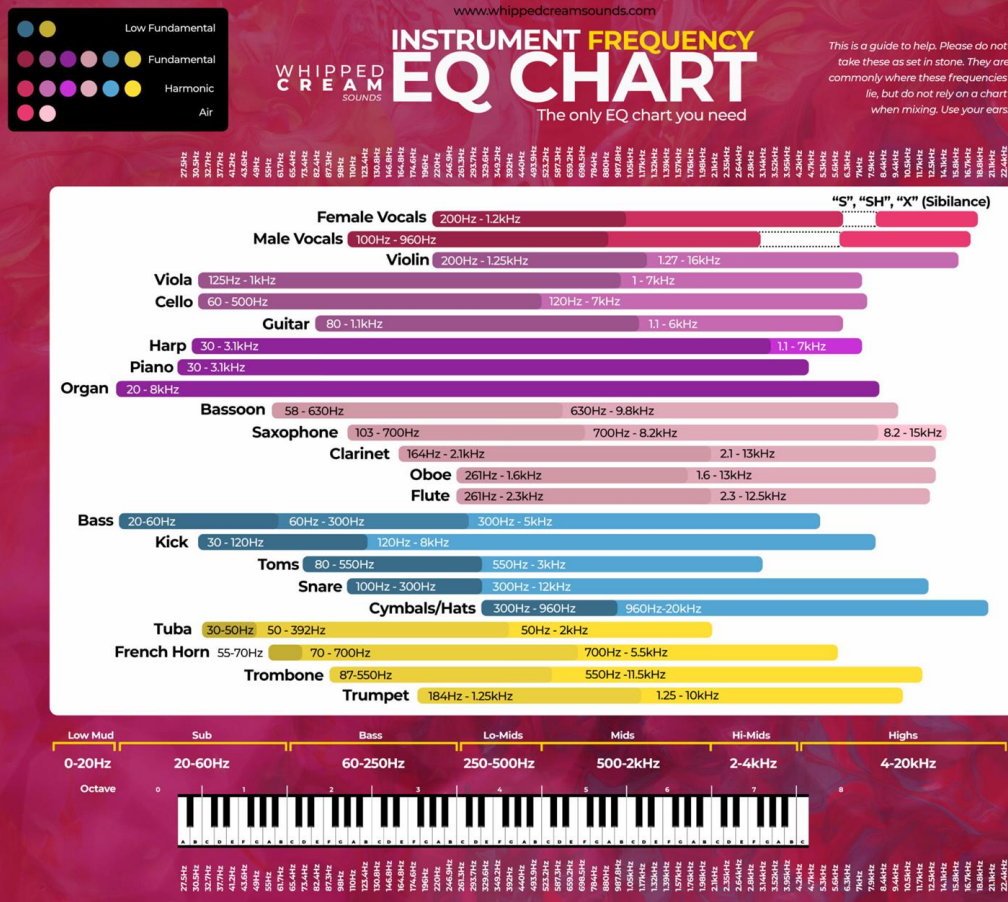
8^{va} 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24 25 26 27 28 29 30 31 32

The musical score consists of two staves. The first staff begins with a bass clef and contains measures 1 through 16. It includes a series of five vertical lines in measure 1, a half note in measure 2, and various other note values and accidentals through measure 16. The second staff begins with a treble clef and contains measures 17 through 32. It starts with a key signature change to one sharp (F#) and continues with a sequence of notes, including many accidentals and fingerings (e.g., 13, 7, 29, 31). The piece concludes with a final note in measure 32.

Melody

- Triads
- Chords
- Online chord progressions
- Arpeggios
- Scales
- Or...just hit keys 'til something sounds good

Harmony



Harmony

- Use as few instruments as you can within a given frequency range
- Lower volume on instruments with harmonic func vs. melody
- Bassline: can replace a percussive element, should be only a few notes; lower notes will be in the same frequency range as some of the bassier drums, thus position the bassline elsewhere in the track
- Filling in with chords: simple is good!

Activity: in teams of 3 or 4, create a looping music track for the *other* of these games:

